

Agile Manifesto Detailed Guide

Introduction to the Agile Manifesto

The Agile Manifesto was introduced in 2001 to improve software development practices and encourage collaboration, adaptability, and customer-focused delivery. It serves as the foundation for Agile frameworks such as Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, XP, and Lean Agile methodologies.

Agile Manifesto Core Values

Individuals and Interactions over Processes and Tools

Agile emphasizes teamwork, collaboration, and communication over rigid processes and tools. People and interactions are considered the key drivers of successful delivery.

Working Software over Comprehensive Documentation

Delivering usable software frequently is more important than producing excessive documentation. Documentation still matters, but working software is the main indicator of progress.

Customer Collaboration over Contract Negotiation

Agile encourages continuous engagement with customers and stakeholders to gather feedback and adapt quickly to changing needs.

Responding to Change over Following a Plan

Agile teams embrace changing requirements and remain flexible to maximize customer value and business outcomes.

The 12 Principles of Agile Software

Customer Satisfaction through Early and Continuous Delivery

Deliver valuable software frequently to satisfy customers and gather rapid feedback.

Welcome Changing Requirements

Agile teams accept changing requirements even late in development to improve customer value.

Deliver Working Software Frequently

Software should be delivered in shorter cycles to increase visibility and adaptability.

Business and Developers Work Together Daily

Continuous collaboration between business and technical teams improves clarity and alignment.

Build Projects around Motivated Individuals

Provide teams with support, trust, and a productive environment for success.

Face-to-Face Communication is Most Effective

Direct communication improves collaboration and reduces misunderstandings.

Working Software is the Primary Measure of Progress

Actual software delivery is the most meaningful way to measure project progress.

Agile Promotes Sustainable Development

Maintain a healthy and sustainable work pace to avoid burnout and maintain productivity.

Continuous Attention to Technical Excellence

Good engineering practices improve agility, maintainability, and product quality.

Simplicity is Essential

Focus on minimizing unnecessary work and reducing complexity.

Self-Organizing Teams Produce Better Results

Empowered teams collaborate effectively and deliver innovative solutions.

Regular Reflection and Continuous Improvement

Teams should continuously inspect and improve their processes through feedback and retrospectives.

Agile vs. Traditional Project Management

Traditional Approach	Agile Approach
Fixed Scope	Flexible Scope
Sequential Delivery	Iterative Delivery
Heavy Documentation	Working Software Focus
Late Testing	Continuous Testing
Limited Customer Collaboration	Continuous Customer Engagement
Rigid Planning	Adaptability to Change

Applications and Benefits

The principles and values of Agile are applicable for Agile learning, Scrum Master interview preparation, GitHub portfolio building, team onboarding, and Agile coaching initiatives.